

Northern Red Oak

Quercus rubra



Origin

Native to eastern North America; one of the most commercially important hardwood trees on the continent and the state tree of New Jersey.

Look for

Its leaf lobes end in sharp bristle-tips rather than rounded points -- a defining trait of the entire red oak group, distinct from the rounded lobes of white oaks like swamp white oak.

IDENTIFICATION TIPS

- Leaf: pointed, bristle-tipped lobes -- part of the 'red oak' group.
- Acorn: wears a shallow cap covering only the top, takes two years to mature.
- Bark: thick, dark, ridged with lighter streaks.
- Commonly confused with: pin oak (northern red oak's lobes are broader and its branches don't show pin oak's distinctive three-tier droop).

THROUGH THE SEASONS

Spring	Reddish new leaves emerge alongside small yellow-green flower clusters.
Summer	Large, pointed-lobe leaves form a broad, rounded crown.
Fall	Leaves turn deep red to reddish-brown.
Winter	Thick, dark ridged bark with lighter streaks is visible on the trunk.

DID YOU KNOW

- Its acorns are an important fall food source for squirrels, blue jays, deer, and wild turkeys -- a single mature oak can produce thousands in a good year.
- It's one of the fastest-growing oaks and can live well over 200 years.